

English Grammar - Direct and Indirect Speech (Shared by English Dept)

Direct speech reports the exact words: He said, "I am going to the market."

Indirect (reported) speech shifts the tense and pronouns: He said that he was going to the market.

Rules:

- Present simple becomes past simple in reported speech
- Past simple becomes past perfect
- Pronouns and time expressions shift: now -> then, today -> that day, here -> there
- Questions: "Where are you going?" -> He asked where I was going.
- Commands: "Close the door" -> He told me to close the door.

Examples for practice:

- She said, "I have finished my homework" -> She said she had finished her homework.
- They said, "We will attend the meeting" -> They said they would attend the meeting.

This handout covers reported speech grammar for semester examinations.